

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Thursday, November 4, 2021, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
At-Large Councilor Dale Girard
At-Large Councilor Michael Demars
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor James Contois
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone

Also present:

Edward Morris, City Manager
Lisa Richmond, Finance Director

NEW BUSINESS

Canvassing the Vote (Charter Article II, Section 14)

City Clerk Gwen Melcher said that there has been a request for a recount, so she checked with the Secretary of State to be sure that Canvassing the Vote could take place tonight. At the recount, there will be a majority of the Council present, so once the recount is complete, Canvass the Vote will also be complete.

Ms. Melcher read the votes from the November 2, 2021, election.

MAYOR

Dale Girard

HAD 1265 VOTES

ASSISTANT MAYOR

Debora Matteau

HAD 1059 VOTES

AT-LARGE COUNCILOR

Nicholas Koloski

HAD 960 VOTES

Lucas “Rocky” Beliveau

HAD 822 VOTES

William Limoges

HAD 791 VOTES

Matthew Mooshian

HAD 721 VOTES

Michael Demars	HAD	<u>709</u>	VOTES
Raymond Hughes III	HAD	<u>474</u>	VOTES
Adam Fontaine	HAD	<u>344</u>	VOTES

WARD I COUNCILOR

Andrew O'Hearne	HAD	<u>250</u>	VOTES
-----------------	-----	------------	-------

WARD II COUNCILOR

James Contois	HAD	<u>400</u>	VOTES
---------------	-----	------------	-------

WARD III COUNCILOR

Jonathan Stone	HAD	<u>280</u>	VOTES
----------------	-----	------------	-------

MODERATOR

WARD I – Courtney Porter	HAD	<u>302</u>	VOTES
WARD II – Alison Raymond	HAD	<u>508</u>	VOTES
WARD III – William Blewitt Jr	HAD	<u>372</u>	VOTES

SUPERVISOR OF CHECKLIST

WARD I; 6yrs – Mary Thomas	HAD	<u>298</u>	VOTES
WARD I; 4yrs – Codi Raymond	HAD	<u>280</u>	VOTES
WARD I; 2yrs – Chad Myhre	HAD	<u>274</u>	VOTES
WARD II – David Pacetti via Write-In Tie	HAD	<u>2</u>	VOTES
WARD III – Melissa Richmond	HAD	<u>389</u>	VOTES

WARD CLERK

WARD I – David Roark	HAD	<u>301</u>	VOTES
WARD II – Mary Ann Beaton	HAD	<u>504</u>	VOTES
WARD III – Brenda Saunders	HAD	<u>382</u>	VOTES

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne that the Claremont City Council, pursuant to Article II, Section 14 of the City Charter, having duly examined the record of the number of votes given in each ward for every person voted for on the ballot, hereby declares the persons having the largest number of votes to be elected and authorizes the city clerk, or her designee, to so notify them of their election.

Roll call vote:
O'Hearne - yes
Girard - yes
Demars - yes

Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Ms. Melcher said the Council is the recount board. The recount has to happen no later than next Thursday, and a quorum of the Council is needed, however, Councilors Koloski and Demars cannot participate in the count as they were on the ballot for At-Large Councilor.

Councilors agreed to do the recount on Wednesday, November 10, at 8:00 a.m., in Council Chambers.

Ms. Melcher said when the list of the write-ins were sent out on election night. David Pacetti's name was not transferred to the list. He received 80 write-in votes for Ward II Councilor. A corrected form has been sent out. Also, someone in Ward II didn't think that his ballot was counted, so the Ward Clerks and Moderator of Ward I counted all the ballots in the machine and confirmed that his ballot had been counted. On another note, a Ward I person had been given two ballots that were stuck together, but the voting machine wouldn't take them, so the blank ballot was taken back to the ballot table.

Councilor Demars said that he had requested a recount because of the 12-vote difference, and the equipment is old, so he feels it is responsible to know that the equipment is functioning as it should.

Councilor Contois said he had previously requested an update on the voting machines at the last Council meeting and the Council was assured they were fine.

Councilor Matteau asked how many mail-in votes were received. Ms. Melcher estimated there were 30 Citywide. To tabulate, the Moderator checks the name and then puts the ballot through the machine.

Councilors thanked Ms. Melcher for all of her hard work.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 6:47 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to adjourn.

Roll call vote:
O’Hearne - yes
Girard - yes
Demars - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council